of 2s. 6d. a week. When prisoners are convicted at Preston or Manchester, and from thence brought hither, the gaoler has a shilling a mile conduct-money for each.

If the large stable which is not much used, and the great room under the shirehall (in which there was only one poor lunatic; who had been there many years, and is since dead) were converted into night-rooms for felons, one small room for each; the court divided, and an infirmary were built, this would be a good gaol. From Mr. Fenton's humanity, and the regard that is justly paid him, I cannot but hope for some of these improvements.

These remarks were made in 1776: at my visit in 1779, I had the pleasure to find six cells made in the upper stable, ten feet by six feet eight inches, each having an aperture about two feet by one and a half; and two good rooms fitted up for an infirmary in the dungeon tower. One of the six cells is appropriated to drunken and riotous debtors, over which this inscription is painted on a board, "This room is for unruly misbehaved debtors, to be confined in, until they promise to behave well."

At my last visit there were three new cells (ten feet by six and a half), two doors in each, one of which was iron-latticed. Here was also a separate closet for women, which is generally wanted in gaols. This gaol is regularly whitewashed, and kept very clean. The Act for preserving the health of prisoners, and the clauses against spirituous liquors, hung up very conspicuously. The gaoler lives distant.

The chaplain's salary, £50, is from the county; and from the Duchy £4.

Much good, I hope, may be expected from the exertions now making by the gentlemen of this county, for the further improvement of their prisons.

COUNTY BRIDEWELL

MANCHESTER. Rebuilt as per date, in the year 1774. Separate courts and apartments for men and women. Two rooms for an infirmary (fourteen feet by eleven feet eight inches). The men have workrooms, over which are chambers. Their four night-rooms or cells in a passage forty-five feet by six, are close; eleven feet by eight; eleven steps below the court; but not properly underground, being on the declivity of a hill. Women have three rooms on the ground-floor, and three chambers: here is a dungeon, down nine steps, fourteen feet by thirteen; an inconvenient bath, no water in it. The iron-grate door into each court has a lock and fastenings of a contrivance singularly curious. No allowance. Keeper's salary was raised from £25 to £60, in lieu of fees, and is now raised to £80 in lieu of the tap.

The Act for preserving the health of prisoners, and the clauses against spirituous liquors, hung up. The keeper is a chandler, and employs some of the prisoners in spinning candlewick at three-halfpence a pound. In the front of the prison is a stone with an aperture into a box, having this inscription: "Sick, and in prison, and ye visited me not."—Matt. xxv, 43.

"By the spirited exertions of Mr. Bayley, and other magistrates, a new prison is building on a large scale, from Mr. Blackburn's plan, in which there will be single cells, and separate apartments for faulty apprentices, etc. This prison will reflect much credit on the good sense and liberality of the hundred of Salford, in this county, which alone defrays all the costs of the building. 1787, 27 Dec., prisoners 53."

[From *An Account of Lazarettos*, p. 206.]

LIVERPOOL BOROUGH GAOL

Seven close dungeons in a passage eleven feet wide, ten steps underground; each six and a half feet by five feet nine inches, and six feet high. Apertures in the doors eleven inches by six. Three prisoners are commonly locked up in each of them at night. There is another dungeon, larger, but not secure. Only one day-room for criminals of both sexes. No infirmary. The keeper told me in November 1775, that after I was there last year and said his prisoners were in danger of the gaol-fever, twenty-eight of them had been ill of it at one time. What led me to think so was, the offensiveness of the dungeons, and the number of prisoners. The prison is surrounded with other buildings, and cannot be made healthy and convenient. Allowance in common on Sunday, bread 4s., beef and broth about 6s. Firing from October to May. Gaoler, Rosendale Allen, sergeant at mace, paid the widow of the late gaoler, £20 a year; and put in a deputy who paid him £65 a year.